Field Artillery Operations

Quick briefing

Recall the four basic field artillery tasks and explain how responsive support depends on a coordinated system.

Know the facts

Field artillery mission · Provide timely, accurate fires in support of ground forces and help integrate fire support into combined arms operations.

Four basic tasks · Support forces in contact, support the concept of operations, synchronize fire support, and sustain field artillery operations.

Tactical roles and effects · Close support, attack at depth or interdiction, and counterfires describe roles. Destruction, neutralization, and suppression describe effects.

System elements · Target acquisition supplies information, fire direction and coordination process it, and survey, meteorology, communications, mobility, and logistics support the system.

Weapon classification · Caliber is one classification. Means of transport is another and includes towed, self-propelled, and aerial transport in the lesson.

Philippine operating environment · Island geography makes the ability to move between locations while maintaining continuity of support an important consideration.

Understand the reasoning

A simulated support request can be answered quickly and still miss the exercise objective if it is out of sequence with the supported unit's plan.

A delay in a single system element can reduce the usefulness of the whole response. Diagnose the information or coordination gap before assuming more equipment will solve it.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

In a Philippine Army map exercise, a simulated artillery element can begin moving to its next training location immediately, but the instructor says exercise communications would be interrupted during the move.

Decision · How should the classroom staff compare moving immediately with waiting for a coordinated handover?

Worked analysis · Identify which exercise activities need support during the interruption and confirm when the receiving cell can take over. Moving early helps meet the next timeline, while a handover protects continuity for the current one. Recommend the sequence that meets the supported unit's highest priority and explain the effect of any remaining gap.

Check yourself

Which basic task aligns artillery with other available fire-support assets? · Synchronize fire support.

How do target acquisition and fire direction differ? · Target acquisition supplies timely, accurate information. Fire direction processes it for coordinated delivery.

Course source

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